Dear Parents & Carers,

At Hunnyhill Primary School, we believe in the importance of equality and everybody having the same opportunities. This is modelled by our staff and taught through lessons and other experiences both discretely and explicitly. One of the subjects that this is taught through is the subject of Personal Development (PD).

As part of our PD curriculum, we follow a scheme called No Outsiders. This scheme was created by Andrew Moffat MBE, who was nominated for the Global Teacher Prize in 2018-19. No Outsiders has three core values:

- Respect for diversity through education in schools;
- Commitment to community cohesion through understanding and acceptance of difference;
- Promotion of dialogue to counter fear and hate in society.

No Outsiders is a scheme that we are introducing in to our school and involves the use of age appropriate story books (see below for a list of the books we use) to teach about seven of the protected characteristics of the Equality Act 2010. Many of the titles you will already be familiar with and may even have copies on your bookshelves at home.

It is important we create a school culture in which children, staff and the whole school community work together to foster an environment of inclusivity through effective spiritual, moral, social and cultural (SMSC) and character education.

We believe it is vital that our pupils can discuss inappropriate and discriminative language and understand how to address boundaries to prepare them for a future in modern Britain.

We strive to ensure that our pupils are surrounded by a consistent message:

- There are no outsiders here;
- Everyone is different;
- We like being different;
- We are all equal in our difference;

- I can get along with you even if we are different;
- We live in the U.K., our British values support this and the law says this too.

We will work alongside our families, parents and carers to deliver this message of inclusivity. You are very welcome to call in for a chat if you would like more information on our pictures books or just pop in to our school office area where all the books are on display. Below is a parent and carer guide that may answer any questions you have.

At Hunnyhill Primary School there are no outsiders - Everyone is welcome!

Hunnyhill Primary School – Book List

Year	Picture Book	Theme
EYFS	The Family Book	All families are different
	You Choose	To choose what you like
	Blue Chameleon	You don't need to change yourself to have friends
	Hello, Hello	To make a new friend
	I love me!	Building confidence & self-esteem
	Super-duper you	What makes you, YOU
Year 1	Errol's garden	To work together
	Elmer	I like the way I am
	Going to the volcano	To join in
	Splash	Positive body image
	The boy who loved everyone	Power of kindness
	Bathe the cat	Busy family life
Year 2	Can I join your club?	To welcome different people
	Amazing	Celebrating diversity & friendship
	How to be a lion	To have self confidence
	My beautiful voice	You have a voice, be heard
	The butterfly	New home, new hope
	Milo imagines the world	You can't judge by appearance
Year 3	Shu-lin's Grandpa	Acceptance
	I am Nefertiti	Self-confidence, friendship and belonging
	The truth about old people	To recognise stereotype
	This is our house	Understand what discrimination means
	The proudest blue	Being proud of who you are
	Is that your mama?	Every family is different
Year 4	Red A crayons story	To be proud of who I am
	Aalfred and Aalbert – A love story	To find common ground
	Julian the mermaid	To show acceptance
	When sadness comes to call	Looking after my mental health
	My shadow is pink	The courage to be true to yourself
	We're all wanderers	Everyone is different
Year 5	You're So Amazing!	To treat everyone the same
	The Girls	To explore friendship
	My World, Your World	World cultures
	And Tango makes three	Families are all equally valid
	The perfect fit	Finding your place

	Mixed	Consider responses to racist behaviour
	Remixed	Families
Year 6	Introducing Teddy	To show acceptance
	My brother George	Inclusiveness
	The Island	To consider causes of racism
	You need to chill	To explore identity and friendship
	The boys	To explore friendship
	A day in the life of Marlan Bundo	To consider democracy

‘All different, All welcome’ A guide for parents and carers

What is an outsider?

Someone who feels left out, who feels like they don’t belong and are not welcome. We want schools to be teaching that there are no outsiders because everyone is welcome. A four-year-old understands what it feels like to be left out and does not want to be left out. We need to create classroom environments where no child feels left out; every child needs to be taught that they belong.

As children grow up, they can sometimes learn that difference is a barrier to friendship. Our aim is to remove that barrier; to quote the Ofsted handbook (2021), we want children to see that ‘difference is a positive, not a negative’. After all, we are all different: none of us is exactly the same; we are all unique. As they move through school, we want children to explore their differences so that they feel comfortable in their own skin. Children should know who they are and feel proud to be who they are, and also know that they are accepted without judgement. No child should feel that they have to change who they are in order to fit in.

So how do we do this? We have an ethos that is backed up by language and behaviour. All children are taught from their first year in school that we are all different and we like that. Wouldn’t the world be boring if we were all the same? In Reception and Years 1 and 2, we use picture books where characters are different, and we show that they are also friends and they play together. We make sure that there are characters that look different in the hope that children will see themselves reflected in those books: “I am different too and that’s ok.”

As children move up the school into Years 3, 4, 5 and 6, we explore reasons why some people might feel left out. After all, it is a fact that prejudice and discrimination exist, and children are going to experience it at some point. We need to prepare them, give them confidence to disagree when they hear prejudice, and show them that they are not alone.

No Outsiders gives children the language to challenge prejudice and show acceptance. Not only will they feel safe knowing they belong, they can also show others that they too are safe: “I will be your friend. You belong here. You don’t have to change; there are no outsiders.”

The Equality Act 2010: British law

Difference is protected under British law. There are very clear aims in the Equality Act that provide guidance for schools. As public bodies, we need

to:
• Have due regard to the need to eliminate discrimination
• Advance equality of opportunity
• Foster good relations between different people when carrying out their activities And who are those different people? The Equality Act references nine ‘protected characteristics’; these are groups of people. No one should face discrimination because of:
• Race
• Religion
• Sex
• Gender reassignment
• Age
• Disabilities
• Sexual orientation
• Pregnancy or maternity
• Marriage or civil partnership
So how do we talk about these different groups in an age-appropriate way to young primary school children? We use picture books that show different people in stories, and we make sure that children understand that no matter who you are, you are welcome in our school.
Consider for a moment whether we should miss out any of the nine protected characteristics when talking about equality in primary school. Are primary school children too young to know about gender reassignment, disability or sexual orientation? How about race or religion? When should we introduce these concepts to children?
This is why No Outsiders works so well in a primary school setting. The lesson plans do not explore the individual protected characteristics; there is not one lesson on race, a different lesson on religion, and another on sexual orientation. In Key Stage 1 there are no discussions about being gay or lesbian and what those words mean; there are no discussions about gender identity or being transgender; there are no discussions about what ‘race’ means or what it means to be black, white or brown; there are no discussions about the religion a five- or six-year-old may follow.
What is discussed in all the lessons, through the picture books used, is difference. All the characters we see in the books are different and they all play together. There are no discussions about what sexual orientation means but there is a story that shows two mummies playing with their daughter. There are no discussions about what race means but there are books showing families with black skin, brown skin and white skin throughout the scheme, and there are stories where children of different races are seen playing and working together. There are no discussions about gender identity but there are stories where boys and girls play and work together and where gender stereotypes are challenged. None of these are explained, questioned or challenged; it’s just who they are.
As children get older, we do talk about ways we might be different or ways others might be different to us, and within those discussions we

encourage children to be proud of who they are. We are not encouraging any child to question their race, religion or gender identity; rather, we are encouraging children to explore and accept the person they are, and we will show they are welcome without judgement in school.